

Saurav Raj Kunwar

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203C Agricultural Sciences, Lubbock, TX. 79409
Updated: August 2026

EDUCATION

- University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign**, Urbana, IL May 2026
PhD, Agricultural and Applied Economics
Dissertation: Three essays on environmental services valuation and agricultural productivity
Committee: Prof. Teresa Serra, Prof. Scott Irwin, Prof. Robert Chambers,
Prof. Laura Gentry & Prof. Gary Schnitkey
- University of Georgia**, Athens, GA May 2020
MS, Agricultural and Applied Economics
Thesis: Understanding profitability of Georgia blueberry growers adopting a stochastic approach
- Tribhuvan University**, Lamjung, Nepal August 2017
BS, Agriculture

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

- Texas Tech University**, Lubbock, TX June 2026 - Present
Postdoctoral Researcher - Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics
Research on agricultural productivity, Total Resource Productivity, and producer decision-making under uncertainty.
- University of Maryland**, College Park, MD January 2023–May 2023
Research Scholar, Agricultural and Resource Economics
Advisor: Professor Robert Chambers

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Production economics; agricultural productivity and efficiency; producer decision-making under risk and uncertainty; land use and conservation; technology adoption and digital agriculture; agricultural policy; environmental and resource economics.

RECENT PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

1. **Kunwar, S. R.**, Chambers, R. G., Gentry, L., & Serra, T. (2026). What are the Carbon Services from Cover-Crop Adoption Worth from Farmers' Perspective? *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*. 108(3): 901-925.
2. Chambers, R. G., **Kunwar, S. R.**, Quiggin, J., Serra, T., & Wang, S. (2025). Estimating Production and Environmental Efficiency under Uncertainty. *Annual Review of Resource Economics*. 17: 85-104
3. **Kunwar, S. R.**, Fonsah, E. G., & Escalante, C. L. (2025). An Assessment of Profitability Using Monte Carlo Simulation Approach: A Case of Georgia Blueberry Industry. *Journal of Food Distribution Research*.
4. Fonsah, E. G., & **Kunwar, S. R.** (2024). Economics of Satsuma Citrus Production Using Drip Irrigation and Frost Protection in the United States. *Agricultural Research & Technology*, 28(4):1-11.
5. Fonsah, E. G., **Kunwar, S. R.**, & Diaz-Perez, J. C. (2023). Economic Evaluation of Bell Pepper Production Under Colored Shade Nets System in the Southeast Region of the USA. *African Journal of Agricultural Economics and Rural Development*, 11(1), 001-007.
6. Bogati, S., **Kunwar, S. R.**, & Amgain, L. P. (2021). Assessment of Nutrient Expert®-Hybrid Maize Model on Productivity and Profitability of Winter Maize in Terai Region of Eastern Nepal. *Heliyon*, 7(10), e08096.
7. **Kunwar, S. R.**, Fonsah, E. G., & Ramirez, O. (2021). Understanding Profitability of Georgia Blueberry

- Growers Adopting a Stochastic Approach. *Journal of Food Distribution Research*, 52(856-2021-1301), 39-45.
8. **Kunwar, S. R.**, Bogati, S., Fonsah, E.G., & Amgain, L.P. (2019). Economic Assessment of Adopting Nutrient Expert® Wheat Model Vs Conventional Wheat Fertilizer Application Management in Morang, Nepal. *Journal of Agricultural Studies*, ISSN: 2166-0379, Vol 7(3): 38-48.

EXTENSION AND STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

1. **Kunwar, S. R.**, & Fonsah, E. G. (2022). Economic Analysis of Southern Highbush Blueberry Production Using Drip Irrigation and Frost Protection in Georgia, USA. *The Journal of Extension*, 60(1), 11.
2. Southern Highbush Blueberry Enterprise Budget, Georgia — **adopted by UGA Extension agents as the standard planning tool for enterprise analysis**. Contributed to the annual budget, 2020–2024. Fonsah, E. G., **Kunwar, S. R.**, Holland, R., Jacobs, J., & Curry, S. College of Agricultural and Environmental Sciences, University of Georgia.
3. Farmdoc analyses using Precision Conservation Management field-level data, 2026–present. Topics include farmland tenure and conservation management, tillage transitions, continued cover-crop use, and yield-profit relationships (*ongoing analyses*).

WORKING PAPERS

Pricing agricultural environmental services under policy-consistent normalizations (Job Market Paper)

Conservation Practices and U.S. Corn Yield Resilience to Weather Shocks *with Robert G. Chambers, Laura Gentry, and Teresa Serra*

Agricultural TFP Convergence in the United States and the Innovation Channel of Public R&D and Patents *with Gangcheol Seo, Krishna Paudel, Kelly Nelson, and Keith Fuglie*

GRANT ACTIVITY

Economic Value of Irrigation Information for Texas High Plains Cotton (*Co-PI*)

USDA-NRCS Conservation Innovation Grants: On-Farm Trials. \$1,000,000 requested, Texas Tech University / Texas A&M University. Submitted July 2026. Expected-value-of-information framework evaluated through a randomized on-farm experiment with producer cooperators.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Comprehensive Resource-Extended State Agricultural Total Factor Productivity *with Krishna Paudel and Keith Fuglie*

Entropy, Total Factor Productivity, and Soil Organic Carbon as a Dynamic Capital Stock (*solo-authored*)

Weather Risk, Resource Misallocation, and Smallholder Productivity: Evidence from Malawi and Ethiopia (*solo-authored*)

Environmental efficiencies and their determinants in the US Midwest *with Robert G. Chambers and Teresa Serra*

Relationship between farm profits, natural capital and management practices *with Laura Gentry and Teresa Serra*

Determinants of agricultural soil erosion: A panel data analysis *with Laura Gentry and Teresa Serra*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lecturer - Aquaculture, Singh Academy, Nepal, 2017-18

- Taught aquaculture fundamentals to high school students.
- Delivered lectures and practical demonstrations.

Teaching Assistant-Commodity Price Analysis, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Spring 2024

- Supported students with empirical assignments involving price analysis in MS Excel.

ADVISING & PROGRAM COORDINATION

- **Graduate Mentor**

- PhD students, University of Illinois Urbana Champaign, Fall 2025
Led an applied production economics reading and problem-solving group to support their dissertation development.
- Master of Agribusiness Program, University of Georgia, 2023-24
Mentored a master's student in research design, data analysis, and thesis development.

- **Graduate Student Seminar Organizer, UIUC, AY 2023–24.**

Organized Food, Agriculture and Commodities Seminar Series with 9 departmental and 3 invited speakers, increasing student participation by 40%.

- **DEI Inclusive Curriculum Design Committee, UIUC.**

Contributed to inclusive course content and recruitment strategies.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT IN TEACHING-LEARNING

AAEA Teaching Academy, 2025 – 2026.

Master Course in Online Teaching (MCOT), March 26–April 9, 2025. CITL, UIUC.

Cultivating Online Learning Communities, January 19, 2025. CITL, UIUC.

Graduate Academy for College Teaching, January 10–11, 2024. CITL, UIUC.

Micro Teaching, January 12, 2024. CITL, UIUC.

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

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| • Anthony Grano Fellowship, | 2025 |
| Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) | |
| • Jon and Joanne Corzine Fellowship, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | 2025 |
| • Selected representative for Catalyzing Advocacy in Science and Engineering (CASE), | 2024 |
| American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS), Washington, D.C. | |
| • Agricultural and Consumer Economics Fellowship, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | 2023–2024 |
| • M. Scott Scholarship, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | 2023 |
| • Selected in Global Young Scientists Summit | 2023 |
| • Stotler Fellowship, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | 2020–2025 |
| • Nepal Government Scholarship, Lamjung Campus, Nepal | 2013–2017 |

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Reviewer: Nature Climate Change, Journal of Productivity Analysis (JPA), Agribusiness, European Journal of Operational Research (EJOR), European Review of Agricultural Economics (ERA), Australian Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics (AJARE), Frontiers in Environmental Science, and The Journal of Extension and Irrigation Science

LEADERSHIP

Treasurer, Graduate Student Organization, Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign AY 2022–23

Student Representative, Institute of Agriculture and Animal Science
Lamjung Campus, Nepal AY 2015–16

ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

Kunwar, S. R., R. G. Chambers, L. F. Gentry, & T. Serra. Pricing of Environmental Services from Agriculture

under Policy Consistent Normalizations. OECD Total Factor Productivity Network, Paris, France. March 18, 2026.

Kunwar, S. R., R. G. Chambers, & T. Serra. Value of Environmental Services from Agriculture. Big Sky Workshop, Montana State University and PERC. June 18-20, 2025.

Kunwar, S. R., R. G. Chambers, L. F. Gentry, & T. Serra. Shadow pricing carbon sequestration and GHG emissions. European Workshop on Efficiency and Productivity Analysis (EWEPA), University of Algarve, Faro, Portugal. June 18-21, 2024.

Kunwar, S. R., R. G. Chambers, L. F. Gentry, & T. Serra. Agricultural greenhouse gas emissions shadow prices: A case of Illinois corn fields. North American Productivity Workshop, University of Miami, USA. June 12–15, 2023.

Kunwar, S. R., R. G. Chambers, L. F. Gentry, & T. Serra. Shadow prices of agricultural greenhouse gas emissions in Illinois. Commercial Agricultural Seminar, Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, USA. October 19, 2022.

Kunwar, S. R., E. G. Fonsah, & O. Ramirez. Understanding Profitability of Georgia Blueberry Growers Adopting a Stochastic Approach. 2020 Food Distribution Research Society Virtual Conference, USA, October 12-13, 2020.

Kunwar, S. R. & L. P. Amgain. Assessing productivity and profitability of wheat using Nutrient Expert wheat model in Nepal. 4th Symposium on Undergraduate Practicum Assessment organized by Research, Development, Training and Extension Center (RD-TEC), Nepal, 2017.

SKILLS

Programming and modeling: R, Stata, Python, GAMS, SAS, SPSS

Production and efficiency analysis: stochastic frontier analysis, production function estimation (Akerberg-Caves-Frazer, Olley-Pakes), directional distance functions, productivity decomposition

Econometrics: panel and spatial methods, causal inference (difference-in-differences, event study, instrumental variables), system GMM, control function estimators, structural modeling, mathematical programming, simulation

Data: farm-level and household panel surveys (LSMS-ISA), geospatial and remote sensing products (CHIRPS, ERA5-Land), watershed and county-scale administrative data, machine learning for large agricultural datasets

Tools: Git/GitHub, LaTeX, reproducible and version-controlled workflows

Languages: English (fluent), Nepali (native), Hindi (fluent)